

FAMILY STUDIES

OVERVIEW

In the social sciences and humanities curriculum, family studies is a multidisciplinary subject area that encompasses four areas: fashion and housing; food and nutrition; general family studies; and raising and caring for children. The topics covered in these areas include, among others: textile production; the functions and design of clothing; the fashion industry; issues related to housing; interior design; the role of nutrition in health; the relationship between food and culture; human and family interactions and development; life management skills; various types of relationships; and considerations related to raising and caring for children.

In family studies courses, students learn about laws and policies that affect individuals and families in Canada and around the world. They also become familiar with the theoretical perspectives and practical research that underpin our understandings of individual and family development. Family studies courses also integrate theory and practical skills. Many expectations can be achieved through practical experiences both in the classroom and in co-op placements, some of which may be affiliated with Specialist High Skills Majors programs.

All courses in family studies encourage students to develop critical and creative thinking skills. Students are given opportunities to deepen their understanding of relevant issues and to develop practical skills, including research and inquiry skills. Students are encouraged to explore a range of perspectives and approaches and to develop the habits of mind that enhance individual, family, and community well-being and contribute to lifelong learning.

FASHION AND HOUSING

Housing and Home Design, Grade 11

Open

HLS30

This course introduces students to a range of issues related to housing and home design. Students will learn about the needs that housing fulfils; housing options; home maintenance and safety; and environmental, economic, legal, and social considerations related to housing. They will use the elements and principles of design to analyse design and decorating decisions. Students will develop research skills as they investigate issues related to housing and home design.

Prerequisite: None

A. RESEARCH AND INQUIRY SKILLS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Exploring:** explore topics related to housing and home design, and formulate questions to guide their research;
- A2. Investigating:** create research plans, and locate and select information relevant to their chosen topics, using appropriate social science research and inquiry methods;
- A3. Processing Information:** assess, record, analyse, and synthesize information gathered through research and inquiry;
- A4. Communicating and Reflecting:** communicate the results of their research and inquiry clearly and effectively, and reflect on and evaluate their research, inquiry, and communication skills.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Exploring

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1.1** explore a variety of topics related to housing and home design (*e.g., careers related to housing and home design; furniture styles; house styles; types of accommodation; technology in the home; eco-housing; eco-textiles; costs of home ownership and renting and their relation to income*) to identify topics for research and inquiry
- A1.2** identify key concepts (*e.g., through discussion, brainstorming, use of visual organizers*) related to their selected topics
- A1.3** formulate effective questions to guide their research and inquiry
Teacher prompt: “What factors would you need to consider if you were researching the costs of renting versus owning a home?”

A2. Investigating

Throughout this course, students will:

- A2.1** create appropriate research plans to investigate their selected topics (*e.g., outline purpose and method; identify sources of information*), ensuring that their plans follow guidelines for ethical research

- A2.2** locate and select information relevant to their investigations from a variety of primary sources (*e.g., interviews, observations, surveys, questionnaires, design plans, photographic spreads in interior design magazines*) and secondary sources (*e.g., textbooks, websites, brochures, magazine and newspaper articles*)

- A2.3** based on preliminary research, for each investigation formulate a research question, and use it to focus their research

A3. Processing Information

Throughout this course, students will:

- A3.1** assess various aspects of information gathered from primary and secondary sources (*e.g., accuracy, relevance, reliability, inherent values and bias, voice*)
Teacher prompts: “How can you determine whether an information source is relevant to your research topic?” “If two information sources contradict each other, how might you determine which is more reliable?” “What values are embedded in the information sources?”
- A3.2** record and organize information and key ideas using a variety of formats (*e.g., notes, graphic organizers, summaries, audio/visual/digital records*)

A3.3 analyse and interpret research information (*e.g., determine whether common themes arise in different sources*)

A3.4 demonstrate academic honesty by documenting the sources of all information generated through research

A3.5 synthesize findings and formulate conclusions (*e.g., weigh and connect information to determine the answer to their research question*)

A4. Communicating and Reflecting

Throughout this course, students will:

A4.1 use an appropriate format (*e.g., presentation board, oral presentation, brochure, poster, multimedia presentation, web page*) to communicate the results of their research and inquiry for a specific purpose and audience

A4.2 use terms relating to housing and home design correctly (*e.g., floor plan, traffic patterns, window coverings, detached, semi-detached, transitional housing, mortgage, lien, escrow*)

A4.3 clearly communicate the results of their inquiries (*e.g., write clearly, organize ideas logically, use language conventions properly*), and follow APA conventions for acknowledging sources (*e.g., generate a reference list in APA style*)

A4.4 demonstrate an understanding of the general research process by reflecting on and evaluating their own research, inquiry, and communications skills

Teacher prompt: “What steps might you take to enhance your research/inquiry skills?”

B. HOUSING NEEDS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Housing and Human Needs:** demonstrate an understanding of the relationship between housing and various human needs and wants;
- B2. Homelessness and Inadequate Housing:** explain what happens to people when their housing needs are not met, and demonstrate an understanding of laws and policies related to housing standards in Canada;
- B3. Housing and the Life Cycle:** demonstrate an understanding of how stages of the life cycle can affect people's choice of and modifications to living spaces.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Housing and Human Needs

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** identify the ways in which housing can meet basic human needs (*e.g., physical, psychological, social, emotional, aesthetic needs*)
Teacher prompts: "Where would the need for housing fit in Maslow's hierarchy of needs?" "What aesthetic needs are related to housing? What are some of the ways in which these needs are satisfied?" "What is the difference between human needs and wants with respect to housing?"
- B1.2** explain, on the basis of comparison of historical and modern living spaces, how housing has evolved to meet human needs (*e.g., insulation, windows, central heating, air conditioning to protect the inhabitants from heat/cold; chimneys, fans, and vents to circulate air and remove harmful fumes and dampness; indoor plumbing and sanitation; doors and locks for security; bans on harmful building substances*)
Teacher prompts: "What characteristics or features of early living spaces met human needs in the past? In what ways have these features been improved over time?" "In what ways have Canadian homes evolved over the past fifty years? In what ways are they the same?"
- B1.3** describe the relationship between personal values, lifestyle, and housing needs and/or preferences (*e.g., the need for families with children*

to be close to schools, for people without cars to have access to public transportation, for people working outside the home to be within commuting distance of their place of employment; the impact of hobbies and lifestyle on housing choices with respect to location and proximity to sports and recreational facilities, cultural institutions, shops, restaurants; the impact of values on choice of neighbourhood or proximity to religious facilities)

Teacher prompts: "What are the most important factors determining where you live? Why?" "To what extent does the desire for status affect a person's choice of neighbourhood?"

- B1.4** describe how and why housing needs and preferences vary in different regions of Canada and throughout the world (*e.g., the impact of factors such as climate, proximity to earthquake or flood zones, local building standards; needs associated with nomadic and sedentary lifestyles, nuclear and extended families; the relationship between financial means, social status, and housing needs/preferences*)

Teacher prompts: "What impact does climate have on people's housing needs?" "How and why would the housing needs of a nomadic community differ from those of a permanently settled community?" "What are some differences in housing and community services between affluent and poor communities or regions?" "What features would you expect to find in houses and apartments that were designed specifically to accommodate extended families?"

B2. Homelessness and Inadequate Housing

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** describe possible effects of homelessness and housing instability on individuals and families (*e.g., physical illness, including tuberculosis; mental illness; nutritional deficiencies; developmental delays in children; increased risk of physical and sexual assault; reduced access to government supports; separation of families*)

Teacher prompts: “What are the risks for teenagers who do not have a permanent home?” “How does the lack of a permanent address affect an individual’s access to government programs and supports?”

- B2.2** explain the effects of living in inadequate housing (*e.g., housing that is overcrowded, has poor ventilation, lacks heating/cooling and/or running water and sanitation facilities, is not adequate to withstand natural disasters common in the region*)

Teacher prompts: “What diseases are associated with lack of access to clean drinking water?” “Why is it important that housing has adequate ventilation? What are some risks for people living in homes with poor ventilation?”

- B2.3** assess the laws and policies that protect the housing rights of individuals and families in Canada (*e.g., the Ontario Human Rights Code, the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act, Residential Tenancies Act*)

Teacher prompt: “In what ways has the reserve system limited the ability of First Nation people to adequately meet their housing needs?”

B3. Housing and the Life Cycle

By the end of this course, students will:

- B3.1** describe what people at different stages of the life cycle (*e.g., young people, newly married couples, single parents, families with young children, families with “boomerang” children, empty nesters, retirees*) look for in a living space

Teacher prompts: “If you were helping a grandparent choose features for his or her living space, what would you look for?” “If you had a family with young children, what housing features would you want?”

- B3.2** describe types of modifications that enhance household access and safety for family members at different stages of the life cycle (*e.g., safety gates, electrical outlet covers, safety bars in bathrooms, stairway lifts, ramps, heat sensors, fenced yards, child locks on cupboards, secondary suites*)

Teacher prompts: “What features are necessary in the bathroom of an elderly person who uses a wheelchair?” “What safety modifications might a family make to their home if they had small children? Why?”

C. SOCIAL, ECONOMIC, AND LEGAL CONSIDERATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. The Impact of Social Factors:** demonstrate an understanding of the impact that social factors, including cultural traditions, can have on housing;
- C2. Housing for Specialized Markets:** demonstrate an understanding of different types of housing, including housing for specialized markets, and of housing-related support programs;
- C3. Economic and Legal Considerations:** demonstrate an understanding of the economic and legal considerations associated with housing.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. The Impact of Social Factors

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** analyse the impact of current social and demographic factors on housing (e.g., *changing family structures, population fluctuations, economic conditions, government policies and services, technological advances, environmental issues, green space regulations*)

Teacher prompts: “How do technological developments affect housing?” “What is the Ontario Greenbelt and what impact does it have on housing developments?” “What impact has increasing urbanization had on housing?” “How have economic factors and government policies affected rates of homelessness?” “What groups are particularly vulnerable to homelessness (e.g., Aboriginal people, new immigrants, people living in poverty, people suffering from mental illnesses)? Why?”

- C1.2** describe how the increased recognition of the need for resource conservation can affect decisions related to living spaces, and identify ways in which householders can conserve energy, water, and other resources (e.g., *by using alternative sources of energy such as solar or geothermal power; by installing low-flow toilets and shower heads; by using recycled building materials; by retrofitting a building with more energy-efficient windows and doors and improving insulation; by using energy-saving appliances, programmable thermostats, dimmer switches, and LED lights; by recycling and composting*)

Teacher prompts: “What are some ways to retrofit a house to be more energy efficient?” “What can apartment or condominium dwellers do to conserve energy?”

- C1.3** explain how cultural traditions and values can affect decisions related to housing (e.g., *with reference to preferred styles of architecture and interior design, the use of feng shui principles, the need for specialized rooms such as shrines, approaches to colour, beliefs about lucky/unlucky numbers, dietary restrictions and kitchen needs, space for extended families living under the same roof*)

Teacher prompts: “What are the principles of feng shui? How and why might they affect the interior design of one’s living space?” “How can kitchens be designed to conform to kosher dietary laws?”

- C1.4** describe how social factors and housing-related technologies may affect housing in the future, and provide reasons to support their predictions (e.g., *the increasing development of high-rise buildings as available land decreases in urban spaces; the availability of more recycled building materials and/or stricter building regulations to conserve natural resources and protect the environment; the development of decentralized communities with single-family housing as more people telecommute to work or school*)

Teacher prompts: “What do you think an environmentally friendly dwelling will look like in the future? Why?” “What urban planning changes do you think will occur in the future? Why?”

C2. Housing for Specialized Markets

By the end of this course, students will:

C2.1 describe common types of housing available in Canada for the general population (e.g., detached and semi-detached houses; row houses; townhouses; duplexes; low- and high-rise apartments, condominiums, and co-op housing; secondary suites in private houses; rooming houses; mobile homes)

C2.2 describe the function and availability of different types of housing, including social housing, for specialized markets (e.g., student residences, group homes, supportive housing, respite housing, shelters for homeless people, family shelters, halfway houses, transitional housing, nursing homes, hospices, subsidized housing for people living on a low income)

Teacher prompts: “What type of housing might be required for a person who was recently released from prison?” “What sorts of housing are available for university/college students?”

C2.3 explain the specific roles of various agencies and programs that assist people to acquire and/or maintain housing (e.g., programs of the Canada Mortgage and Housing Corporation, including the Emergency Repair Program, Home Adaptations for Seniors’ Independence, and Residential Rehabilitation Assistance Program; the First Nations Market Housing Fund; housing loan guarantees from the Department of Indian and Northern Affairs; Affordability and Choice Today; the Ontario Disability Support Program; Ontario Works; rent-supplement programs; non-profit housing programs; Habitat for Humanity; community-based agencies such as the United Way, religious groups, rent bank programs, legal services to help prevent eviction)

Teacher prompts: “What programs are available in your community to assist with various housing needs?” “How might a single parent on social assistance access available housing services?” “What is the process of applying for housing assistance if your home is damaged in a storm?”

C3. Economic and Legal Considerations

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 demonstrate an understanding of different models of housing ownership or tenancy in Canada and other countries (e.g., freehold, condominium, or cooperative ownership; co-housing; rental of public, subsidized, or private housing; company housing; sharecropping rentals)

C3.2 identify the ongoing costs associated with various types of housing (e.g., rent; mortgage payments; condominium fees; property taxes; repairs; home or contents insurance; utility, telephone, Internet, cable expenses)

Teacher prompt: “Which housing-related expenses are discretionary and non-discretionary? How can changes in ongoing non-discretionary expenses be controlled or predicted?”

C3.3 describe the financial obligations associated with acquiring housing (e.g., first and last month’s rent, down payment, deposit, mortgage, lawyers’ and real estate agents’ fees)

Teacher prompts: “In addition to the purchase price, what are some of the financial costs associated with buying a house or condominium?” “Under what circumstances would it be more financially viable to rent rather than purchase accommodation?”

C3.4 describe the legal obligations associated with buying and renting housing (e.g., with reference to leases, subletting, an offer to purchase, escrow, liens, closing; illegal practices such as asking for “key money”)

Teacher prompts: “What documents does the vendor have to provide when selling a house?” “What legal processes are required for someone buying a house?” “What legal recourse does a tenant have when a landlord is not abiding by the law?”

C3.5 describe factors to be considered in determining the affordability of accommodation (e.g., level and stability of one’s income, savings and debts, number of dependants, plans to have children, money needed for non-discretionary expenses, values and goals, interest rates)

C3.6 summarize housing-related services and regulations available in Canadian communities (e.g., garbage collection; water and sanitation; energy services; tree-planting and maintenance services; regulations relating to zoning for rental accommodations or rooming houses, building codes, environmental assessment; legislation such as landlord and tenant acts; property taxes)

Teacher prompts: “What services are in place in your community to support homeowners?” “What types of services are available in large cities that might not be available in small towns or rural areas?” “What legislation applies to landlords and tenants? What protections and obligations are contained in this legislation?”

D. CREATING AND MAINTAINING LIVING SPACES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Functional Floor Plans:** demonstrate the ability to create and evaluate floor plans for living spaces;
- D2. Design and Furnishing Considerations:** demonstrate an understanding of the elements and principles of design and other considerations related to designing and decorating living spaces;
- D3. Home Maintenance:** demonstrate an understanding of the importance of home maintenance and of ways to create a safe and healthy home;
- D4. Career Opportunities in Housing:** describe various careers associated with housing, including home maintenance and design, and the educational pathways related to them.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Functional Floor Plans

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** demonstrate an understanding of the terminology relating to, and drawing conventions used in, floor plans (*e.g., conventions used in architectural drawings and floor plans, including those for doors, walls, windows, kitchen and bathroom fixtures, laundry facilities, closets and storage; electrical symbols*)

- D1.2** using floor plans, evaluate the effectiveness of interior design decisions (*e.g., the positioning and function of various rooms, including social zones, private spaces, work areas; the placement of appliances and furnishings; the number and location of electrical outlets; orientation of windows for solar gain; decisions with respect to traffic patterns, accessibility, clearance, storage; fire and emergency measures*)

Teacher prompt: “How effectively do common condominium floor plans accommodate the needs of families with young children? The needs of elderly people?”

- D1.3** demonstrate the ability to create a floor plan for a specific purpose (*e.g., for a bedroom, home office, garage; for a recreational space in a backyard; showing an emergency evacuation plan*)

Teacher prompts: “What elements are needed in a home office? How could you put them together for maximum convenience and efficiency?” “What is meant by the term *work triangle* in a kitchen? How does the size and shape of the kitchen affect how you approach the design of the triangle?”

D2. Design and Furnishing Considerations

By the end of this course, students will:

- D2.1** demonstrate an understanding of basic terminology relating to styles of architecture, furniture, and interior design (*e.g., Saltbox, Cape Cod, Georgian houses; French provincial, colonial, retro, eclectic, country, contemporary, minimalist design/furniture*)

- D2.2** analyse ways in which elements and principles of design (*e.g., line, space, harmony, texture, colour*) are used to create interior and exterior home environments

Teacher prompt: “What are some ways in which colour themes are used in rooms featured in home design magazines?”

D2.3 analyse the interrelationship between the elements and principles of design, practical considerations, and the range of available products with respect to home-decorating decisions (e.g., how the size and shape of a room influence the type, style, and placement of furniture; how natural light may influence decisions about wall colour, window coverings, lighting; how the function of a room affects decisions about flooring, furniture materials, decoration; how the availability of environmentally friendly and energy-efficient products may influence design decisions; how the size and purpose of a yard and the amount of sun and shade affect landscaping decisions)

Teacher prompts: “When redecorating your bedroom, why do you have to consider the room’s size and shape?” “What furniture size and styles best suit a small loft apartment? Why?” “How can you make your kitchen both functional and aesthetically pleasing?”

D2.4 describe the criteria involved in selecting home furnishings, equipment, and appliances (e.g., product reputation, durability, function, safety, cost, maintenance, energy efficiency, design, aesthetic appeal)

Teacher prompt: “If you were furnishing your first apartment, what factors would you consider most important? Why? In what areas might you have to compromise? Why?”

D2.5 demonstrate an understanding of skills, technologies, and techniques that can be used to inexpensively enhance personal spaces (e.g., with reference to creating their own household accessories or home décor items; doing their own floor or wall tiling, painting, wall papering, gardening; reupholstering or refinishing furniture; building shelving or other storage, decks, fences; ways of reusing or repurposing building materials; shopping in used housewares stores; using computer software applications to help them make design decisions)

D3. Home Maintenance

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 describe proper home maintenance, including preventive maintenance (e.g., maintaining the roof, servicing the furnace/air conditioner, cleaning and repairing the eaves, shutting off water to outdoor taps in the fall, painting or staining exterior wood, tuckpointing masonry, cleaning ducts, replacing chipped caulking, checking smoke and carbon monoxide detectors)

D3.2 describe strategies for maintaining a healthy home environment (e.g., limiting use of household chemicals or choosing environmentally responsible

products; using proper waste disposal and recycling procedures; using safe and appropriate pest control; using exhaust fans in the kitchen and bathroom; cleaning, vacuuming, and dusting regularly; mopping up spills and fixing leaks promptly; replacing furnace/humidifier filters)

D3.3 identify household hazards and outline related safety precautions (e.g., installing a home security system, childproofing cupboards, storing toxic or flammable substances safely or avoiding their use altogether, removing snow and ice, ensuring fire extinguishers are in working order, installing and regularly checking smoke and carbon monoxide detectors, avoiding overloading electrical outlets, cleaning dryer ducts)

D3.4 identify household repairs that can generally be done by the occupant of the home (e.g., replacing a toilet seat, cupboard handles, furnace filters) and those that require a professional (e.g., replacing electrical wiring, duct cleaning, plumbing)

D3.5 explain the possible impact of failing to properly maintain and repair a home (e.g., water damage and mould from leaky pipes and/or roof or from clogged eavestroughs; structural instability from cracks in the foundation; air leaks from windows or doors that are not properly hung, caulked, and/or weather stripped; fire hazards associated with old wiring; increased energy use associated with poorly insulated spaces)

Teacher prompts: “What would happen if missing roof shingles were not promptly replaced?” “Why is it important to properly caulk a bathtub/shower?”

D4. Career Opportunities in Housing

By the end of this course, students will:

D4.1 identify and describe career opportunities related to housing and home design/maintenance (e.g., realtor, lawyer, mortgage officer, landlord, developer, property manager, social housing coordinator, home inspector, home stager, designer, decorator, painter, wallpaper hanger, insurance professional, architect, colour specialist, kitchen planner, landscape architect, electrician, plumber, space planner, storage organizer)

Teacher prompt: “What types of professionals are involved in the development, design, construction, and purchase of a new home? Which are involved in home maintenance?”

D4.2 describe the educational pathways most appropriate for various careers related to housing and home design/maintenance